

THE FASCIA RELEASE GUIDE

Move easier, feel stronger, live with energy — by Claire Mei Nakamura

Welcome to Your Fascia Release Guide



I'm Claire. I'm 66, I ride gravel, I train for strength — and I've spent the last decade learning how to keep my body moving, pain-free and full of energy. But this guide isn't only about where I am now. It's about the whole stretch of years between the first time your body started feeling different — maybe in your mid-30s, maybe later — and wherever you are today. Because here's what I've learned talking to women at every stage of this transition: the changes don't wait for a birthday. Perimenopause can quietly start in your late 30s or early 40s. Menopause arrives on its own timeline. And the body you have at 38 needs almost the same patient, consistent care as the body you have at 68 — just at a different volume. This guide is the part I wish I'd had from day one: a clear, gentle, progressive way to understand your fascia and release the tension that builds up as your hormones and your habits both shift. By the time you finish it, you will know what fascia is, why it tightens, how to release it safely at home with simple tools, and how to turn it into a daily habit that keeps you mobile, strong and steady — at 35, at 55, and beyond. Your results, not a medical promise. This guide is a wellness and mobility program. It is not medical advice and does not replace a healthcare professional. If you have a known condition (osteoporosis, spine issues, blood thinners), a recent injury, or any doubt — ask your doctor or a physiotherapist before starting.

This Isn't About Getting Older

Let's name the real fear first, because I think it matters more than any stretch or roller. It usually isn't "I'm a bit stiff." It's quieter and heavier than that: "Is this who I am now? Am I becoming someone who can't keep up?" Maybe it's your hips after a long drive. Maybe it's waking up feeling like your body aged overnight. Maybe it's the frustration of a body that used to just — work, and now seems to negotiate with you. If any of that sounds familiar, you're not imagining it, and you're not alone. It's also not the end of the story. Fascia release won't turn back the clock, and I won't pretend it does. What it does is give you back a working relationship with your body — something concrete to do, before you're in pain, that keeps you capable of the life you actually want: walking easily, playing on the floor with a grandchild, riding a bike, carrying your own groceries, trusting your own back. You don't have to get younger. You can get stronger, and steadier, starting today.

Meet the Fascia: Your Body's Living Web



The word fascia comes from the Latin for 'band' or 'bundle'. It is a continuous web of connective tissue — mostly collagen and water — that wraps around, connects and supports every muscle, bone, organ, nerve and blood vessel in your body. Think of it as the body's inner tablecloth: tugging one corner shifts everything else. When your fascia is healthy, it is supple, elastic and well-hydrated. Layers slide past one another so you can reach, twist, bend and stride freely, without restriction or pain. That effortless glide is what mobility actually feels like. A web, not a set of separate parts. For a long time, the body was studied as separate parts: this muscle bends the arm, that one lifts the leg. But your fascia is one continuous, all-encompassing network. It connects everything. This is why a tight hip can pull on your lower back, and why releasing one area so often frees another you were not even working on. What Changes — From Perimenopause Through Menopause Aging itself does not automatically destroy fascia, but our habits and our hormones both leave a mark on it. Over years, several everyday factors make fascia sticky, clumpy and full of restrictions — the familiar 'knots' and bands of tension:

- Sedentary days and long hours sitting
- Repeated poor posture
- Dehydration (fascia needs water to glide)
- Stress and shallow breathing
- Poor or short sleep
- Overusing or underusing muscles

- The natural loss of elasticity in connective tissue over time

On top of these habits, hormones add their own layer — and this is where perimenopause often catches women off guard. Estrogen supports collagen production and tissue hydration. As it starts to fluctuate in perimenopause (commonly from the mid-30s to late 40s) and then drops further after menopause, connective tissue can genuinely feel drier, stiffer and slower to bounce back. This isn't in your head, and it isn't only a 'post-menopause' story — many women notice the first signs years before a doctor would call it menopause. Please hear the honest part of this: those changes are real, but they are not a sentence.

- Consistency matters more than ever — regular care builds on itself, at any age this shift starts for you.
- Hydration and protein support the tissue your hormones may no longer fully provide.
- Release becomes daily maintenance, not a fix-it-when-it-hurts tool.
- Strength work protects bones and connective tissue — a gentle, progressive program pays back.
- You may need slightly longer or more regular sessions than you did ten years ago; that is normal and

fine. I share this because I remember feeling frustrated that 'the old elasticity' was gone. What I found instead was a new kind of body knowledge — one built on attention, consistency and kindness rather than elasticity alone. The good news: your fascia responds to care at every stage. Like a garden, it thrives on steady, gentle attention, and you can start anywhere, at any age.

Why Release the Fascia? The Real Benefits

People talk about fascia release as if it were a fad. For me, it is the quiet foundation of everything else I do. When my body glides, I ride stronger, I sleep better and I move through my day without that low-level ache that used to follow me everywhere. Benefit What it means day to day Improved mobility & range of motion Reach, bend and twist more freely and comfortably. Better alignment and symmetry The body works as one connected whole, not piece by piece. Increased blood flow Faster recovery after activity, warmer, more alive feeling. Less everyday pain Fewer of those nagging tight spots in neck, back and hips. Lower injury risk Tissues that slide are tissues that give instead of tear. More energy A body free of tension costs less to move. These are the benefits I have felt personally over years of practice — not promises, but genuine, repeatable outcomes of staying consistent.

Understanding Your Own Body



Before you touch a roller, spend a little time noticing. Your body has been quietly telling you where it holds tension for months, maybe years. The wisest thing I did was to start listening. Your body's tension map

- Neck and shoulders — where stress and screens collect.
- Lower back — the great carrier of everything.
- Hips and glutes — the engine room, and a common tight spot.
- Hamstrings — often tight from sitting.
- Calves and feet — our connection to the ground.
- Chest and the front of the shoulders — from rounding forward.

The 60-second body scan Stand comfortably, close your eyes, and breathe slowly. Let your attention travel from the crown of your head down through your face, neck, shoulders, back, hips, legs and feet. Where does the body feel heavy, tight, or guarded? Where does it feel easy? Take note. That map — and not a diagram — is your starting point.

The Three Pillars of My Routine

You do not need a gym, a coach or expensive equipment. My whole approach fits into three simple pillars that work together. Each one is gentle, and together they are powerful. Pillar What it is What it does Self-massage (foam roll / ball) Slow, steady pressure on tight Breaks up restrictions, restores zones, 30–60s each glide Gentle stretching Each stretch held 30s to 1 min, Lengthens muscle, relaxes never forced fascia Daily movement Walking, mobility, riding Feeds fascia through circulation and use

What You Need: Simple Tools, Nothing Fancy



One of the things I love about this practice is how accessible it is. Start with what you have, add one or two tools when you are ready. Quality matters more than quantity — pick one tool and learn to use it well.

- A firm foam roller — often all you need to begin
- A small massage ball — precise for shoulders, hips and feet
- A yoga mat or towel for floor comfort
- Water within reach — hydration is what feeds your fascia
- Optional: a foot dome or calf-raiser to stretch the arches
- Comfortable clothing you can move and roll in

Your 10-Minute Daily Routine



The golden rule: gentle and consistent beats intense and rare. A deep, comfortable tension is the goal — never sharp pain, never compression, never tingling. If it hurts, ease off, slow down, or ask a professional. The routine below is my home base — the version I do most days. It takes ten minutes, needs almost no space, and covers the areas that matter most for daily comfort. You'll find the detailed zone-by-zone breakdown in the next chapter.

Minutes 1–3 — Waking up your body

- Lie back on the roller under your upper back and shoulder blades.
- Take three slow, full breaths.
- Roll gently forward and back in a short, swaying range.
- Pause 30 seconds on any spot that 'talks to you'.

Minutes 4–7 — The zones that carry you

- Calves: roll from ankle toward knee, one leg crossed for more pressure.
- Hamstrings: seated, roller under thigh, shift weight into the tender spots.
- Hips and glutes: sit onto the small ball, slow small circles for 30–60 seconds.
- Never press directly on bones, spine or neck.

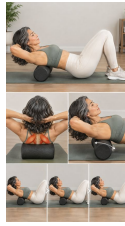
Minutes 8–10 — Extending the release

- Stretch quads and back, hold 30 seconds, release, repeat twice.
- Rock the pelvis on the floor to free the lower back.
- Stand and finish with three big breaths, shoulders relaxed — feel the space.

Zone by Zone: A Complete Walkthrough

Now let's go deeper. This chapter walks through each major zone in detail, with the exact movements I use. Take it slowly, one zone per session at first. You are not repairing a car engine — you are watering a garden.

1. Upper back and shoulder blades



Release the upper back and shoulders on the roller. Lie on your back over the roller so it sits under your upper back and shoulder blades, knees bent, head supported. Breathe in, and on the exhale let your body settle. Cross your arms over your chest and gently sway side to side, small circles, and pause wherever you feel a held tension. Spend one to two minutes here. Keep clear of the cervical spine and lower back.

2. Calves



Roll the calf from ankle to knee. Sit on the floor, place one calf over the roller, and lift your hips slightly so your weight presses down. Cross your other leg over the working leg for more pressure if you like. Roll slowly from just above the ankle toward the knee, staying off the bone. When you find a tender spot, hold and breathe into it for 30 to 45 seconds.

3. Hamstrings



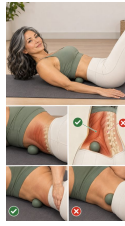
Sink into the back of the thigh. Remain seated with the roller under one thigh. Use your hands behind you for support and shift your weight so it sinks into the tender spots along the back of the thigh. Roll slowly; hold and breathe where it is tight. These respond well to patience.

4. Hips and glutes



Small circles on the glute, breathing in. The hips are where so much of our tension hides. Sit onto a small massage ball placed under the firm flesh of one glute, leaning back on one hand, other hand resting on your knee. Make slow, small circles; when you find a tender point, pause and breathe for 45 seconds. Switch sides. Off the bone, always.

5. Lower back (sides, not the spine)



Free the lower back beside the spine. I do not roll directly on the lower spine. Instead, lie or sit so a small ball or the edge of the roller presses into the muscle bands beside the spine. Rock gently side to side, breathing. This frees the lumbar area without risking the bones.

6. Feet and arches



Roll the arch of the foot. Our feet carry us all day and are easy to ignore. Roll the sole of one foot over a small ball or a foot dome, from the heel to the ball of the foot, working slow circles over the arch. This releases a surprising amount of whole- body tension.

Breathe Your Way Into the Release



Your breath is the quiet partner of every release. Shallow, quick breathing — the kind stress produces — keeps the body guarded. Slow, full breathing tells the nervous system it is safe to let go.

- Inhale through the nose for a slow count of four.
- Exhale through the nose or mouth for a slow count of six.
- Exhale as you press into a tender spot — letting go on the breath.
- Never hold your breath during a release; keep it long and even.

You will feel the difference almost immediately. The release happens as much in the nervous system as in the tissue — and breathing is the bridge between the two. The Nervous System: Why You Stay Tense Here is what surprised me most when I learned about my own body: a lot of chronic tension is not muscle — it is the nervous system holding on. When you are stressed, rushed or always 'on', your body stays in a low-level guard. That guard is what makes tissue tight and hard to release, no matter how hard you press. Releasing the fascia is also a conversation with your nervous system. Slow, rhythmic pressure, warm sensory input, long exhales and unhurried movement all signal safety. Over time this teaches the body it is allowed to soften — which is why the breathing and the pace matter as much as the rolling. One habit that changed everything: I stopped treating release as 'work to endure' and started treating it as 'time to come home to my body'. The very attitude shift made the tissue respond differently.

Safety First: Listen to Your Body

- Never roll directly on the lower spine or neck — keep contact on the large muscle bellies.
- Start with light pressure and increase gradually over several weeks.
- Avoid rolling over swollen, irritated or injured areas.
- Drink water after each session.
- Known condition (osteoporosis, spine, blood thinners)? Get medical clearance first.

- Nothing should ever cause sharp pain, tingling or numbness.



When to stop and check in: tenderness during a release is normal. Sharp or shooting pain, numbness, or pain that worsens day over day is not. Stop, rest, and speak with a healthcare professional before continuing. How to Load the Pressure (Without Overdoing It) One of the most common questions I get is 'how hard should I press?'. The answer is simpler than people expect: press just enough to feel a deep, spreading sensation — think of it as melting into the tissue, not stabbing it.

- Start lightly and let the tissue invite more over time.
- Use your body weight, not muscle force — lean, don't strain.
- If you feel the need to tense up or hold your breath, you are too heavy.
- Breathe out as you sink in; let the exhale do the work.
- 30–60 seconds per spot is plenty — longer is not better.

A good test: you should feel a satisfying 'release' sensation, like a tight knot loosening, within 30–45 seconds. If you feel nothing but mild discomfort, back off a little and let the breath meet the tissue.

Hydration: Water Is What Makes It Glide



Fascia is mostly collagen and water. When you are dehydrated, it becomes drier, stiffer and more prone to sticking — no technique will glide well on dry tissue. Hydration is not a side note; it is part of the release itself.

- Drink small amounts steadily through the day, not all at once.
- A simple guide: aim for plenty of water, especially in the first half of the day.
- Drink extra after a session — releasing tissue can leave you thirsty.
- Herbal tea, soups and juicy fruit all count toward your fluid.

What To Eat (and Skip) for Supple Tissue



I am not a nutritionist, and I will never tell you what everyone should eat. But I have noticed the habits that support my recovery the most, and I share them as 'here's what helped me' — not as a prescription. Supports the fascia Often adds stiffness Steady hydration and fluids Very low fluid intake A variety of colorful vegetables Long stretches of highly processed foods Enough protein for repair Relying on crash diets Whole foods, eaten calmly Too much sugar and refined carbs Above all, be kind to yourself. Nutrition is one piece of the puzzle, and perfection is not the goal — consistency is.

Common Myths, Set Straight

- Myth: 'You must be in pain for it to work.' — Truth: No. Comfortable, deep tension is the goal.
- Myth: 'Fascia release replaces exercise.' — Truth: It complements it; movement is what feeds healthy tissue.
- Myth: 'Rolling directly on the spine is fine.' — Truth: Keep pressure on the muscle bellies, off the bones.
- Myth: 'It's only for athletes, or only for after menopause.' — Truth: It's for anyone who wants to move with less pain, whatever stage of the transition they're in.

Your Progressive Plan



Consistency is the whole game. Ten minutes every day changes your body far more than an hour once a month. Here is the arc I recommend to a friend beginning this practice — it builds pressure, time and confidence slowly, so you never feel rushed and never get hurt. Whether you're 37 or 67, the arc is the same; only the pace you take it at may differ. Weeks Focus Sessions / week 1–2 Learn the zones. Light pressure. A body scan each day. 2–3 3–4 Add calves and glutes. Begin breathing into tender 4 spots. 5–6 Add hips, feet and upper back. Hold each spot a little 4–5 longer. 7–8 Combine with strength, walking and riding. Full 10- 5 minute routine. If a week feels like too much, do less. The plan is a guide, not a test. What matters is that you keep returning. Pick Your Weekly Rhythm Once you're past week two, choose the rhythm that fits your actual week — not the one you think you should want. You can switch between them any time. Day Balanced Gentle Mon Upper back + chest Body scan + breath Tue Calves + hamstrings Gentle full-body stretch Wed Hips + glutes 5-min neck & shoulders Thu Feet + lower back Body scan + calves Fri Full 10-min routine Full 10-min routine Sat Shoulders + chest, or movement Evening wind-down (ride/walk) Sun Rest or light stretch Rest Short on time on any given day? Split the body instead of skipping it: an upper-body day (neck, shoulders, upper back, chest) and a lower-body day (glutes, hips, hamstrings, calves, feet) cover everything just as well over two sessions. Pick one option and adapt as you go. The perfect week is the one you actually keep.

Signs You're Making Progress

- You touch your toes more easily, without forcing.
- Your shoulders feel lighter at the end of the day.
- Your back is more supple in the morning.
- Fewer aches after a long day sitting or driving.
- Movement feels like freedom again, not effort — that is the real goal.

Keep a Simple Journal

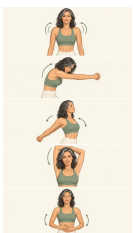


You do not need an app or a notebook system. A simple note of a few lines goes a long way in spotting your progress:

- Date and what you worked on.
- How the body felt before and after (tighter, easier, looser?).
- One thing you noticed or one spot that 'talked'.
- How you felt afterward, not just physically — calmer, more capable, more yourself?

Looking back after a month, that little record will show you how far you have come — in your body, and often in how you feel about it. That is deeply motivating.

The 5-Minute Upper-Body Ritual



Between screens and long days, the shoulders and neck carry a lot. This little ritual releases the whole upper body in under five minutes — perfect for mornings, after a ride, or before sleep.

- Ear to shoulder: 2 x 20 seconds each side.
- Slow head rolls, 4 gentle circles each way.
- Shoulder circles backward then forward, 8 reps.
- Arms crossed at chest, gentle pull, 20 seconds each arm.

- Hands behind back, open the chest, breathe 20 seconds.

Short, simple and repeatable. The little rituals you actually do are the ones that keep you strong.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to hurt for it to work? No. Aim for comfortable, deep tension — never pain. Gentle and regular always beats hard and rare. How long until I see results? Pain and tightness often improve quickly; lasting mobility gains build over 2–4 weeks of regular practice. I'm tight everywhere. Where do I start? With the calves and glutes — two easy zones that release a great deal of tension in the rest of the body. I'm in my late 30s or early 40s — is this too early for me? Not at all. If your hormones are shifting, your fascia is already feeling it, even if no one's called it 'perimenopause' yet. Starting now, before things get uncomfortable, is exactly the right time. Is fascia release safe over 60? Done gently, it is a common mobility practice. With any known condition, get medical advice first. Does it replace exercise? No — it complements it. Release prepares the fascia; movement (walking, riding, stretching) feeds it. Do I need the same tools as you? No. A single firm roller is enough to begin. Start with what you have and add slowly.

Your First-Weeks Checklist

- My tools are ready (roller + ball + mat + water).
- I know my golden rule: comfortable tension, zero sharp pain.
- I've found my 'talking' zones (calves, glutes, shoulders?).
- I've done a 60-second body scan and written down three notes.
- I've scheduled my 10-minute routine at a time I can keep.
- Week one: I start with 2–3 sessions, light pressure.

A Word About Results and Honesty

I want to be straight with you. No amount of stretching erases a medical condition, and I will never sell you a miracle. What I can offer is what helped me: a patient, consistent way to treat your fascia and keep your body on your side. Your only job is to show up. Reminder: this is a wellness and mobility program, not medical advice. Listen to your body, stay gentle, and ask a healthcare professional about anything that concerns you.

Morning vs. Evening: When to Release



The time of day changes what your body needs. Building a rhythm for both makes the practice feel effortless rather than forced. Morning: waking the body up

- Start with the breath and the body scan — notice where you are stiff.
- Roll the upper back and the glutes with light pressure.
- Keep it short (3–5 minutes); you are waking up, not working out.
- Hydrate before or with your routine.

Evening: releasing the day

- Use the fuller 10-minute routine to let go of the day's holding.
- Move slower, breathe longer, keep the lights low.
- This is a powerful pre-sleep ritual — it calms the nervous system.
- Finish with feet and a final body scan to notice what has changed.

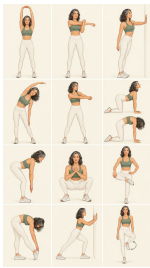
The Desk Worker's Field Guide



If you spend hours at a screen — whether working, writing or scrolling — your fascia spends those hours in a familiar fold. Here are the small interventions that keep a chair-bound body comfortable.

- Every 45–60 minutes, stand, raise your arms overhead and take a slow breath.
- Set a phone timer for a 2-minute neck-and-shoulder break.
- Roll the upper back behind your chair for a minute mid-day.
- Tuck your chin and lengthen the neck while you work.
- Hydrate at your desk — a water bottle you actually see.
- At the end of the day, a 5-minute upper-body release prevents the 'fold' from settling in.

Your Movement Library: 12 Everyday Moves



Choose freely from this list. Each move is a tool; you do not need all of them every day. Pick three or four that your body asks for, and rotate.

- Standing forward fold (bend gently, let the back of the legs open).
- Seated spinal twist (open the shoulders and ribs).
- Cat-cow on hands and knees (mobilize the spine).
- Pigeon stretch (open the hips).
- Quad stretch standing, holding a wall.
- Hamstring stretch, foot raised on a step.
- Calf stretch at a wall, heel down.
- Chest opener with hands behind the back.
- Shoulder doorway stretch.
- Neck side-bend, ear to shoulder.
- Ankle rolls and foot arches over a ball.
- Child's pose to rest and breathe.

Sleep: The Quiet Repair Vehicle



You cannot stretch or roll your way out of poor sleep. The body repairs and rehydrates tissue while you rest, and there is no substitute for a good night. This is not a lecture — it is the honest truth I wish someone had told me earlier.

- An evening release ritual supports the wind-down to sleep.
- Dark, cool, quiet bedrooms help the nervous system settle.
- Consistent sleep and wake times build the repair cycle.
- Hydrate well during the day so you are not dry overnight.

- If sleep is hard for you — including the sleep disruption some women notice through perimenopause — treat that as part of your mobility work. It deserves as much care as the roller.

A Note on Strength Around the Release



Release makes you mobile; strength makes that mobility safe to use. The two are partners. Strong muscles and bones protect the joints and connective tissue, which matters at every stage of this transition — and especially as estrogen's protective effect on bone density declines. Start light, progress slowly, and let a program built for real, changing bodies guide you — the goal is capability, not lifting records.

Glossary: The Words I Use

Term What it means
Fascia The continuous web of connective tissue around muscles, organs and bones.
Myofascial release Pressure work that frees restrictions in the connective tissue.
Restriction / adhesion An area of 'sticky' tissue that limits glide and movement.
Foam rolling Using a roller to apply comfortable pressure along muscles.
Trigger point A tender, over-active spot in the tissue.
Mobility The ability to move a joint through its full, pain-free range.
Body scan A slow mental tour of the body to notice where tension lives.
Perimenopause The transition years — often starting in the mid-30s to 40s — when hormone levels begin to fluctuate before menopause.

Recovery After a Ride



Cycling is joyful and freeing, but it also works the body in one direction for a long time — forward, bent, legs circling. A short release after a ride keeps you balanced and comfortable for the next one.

- Open the chest and front of the shoulders (release the forward fold).
- Free the hips and glutes — the engine room of every pedal stroke.
- Roll the calves and hamstrings after time in aero or bent-hipped positions.
- Stretch the quads gently; long rides load them heavily.
- A 5-minute version is enough to feel the difference.

Think of it as brushing your teeth after a good meal: a small, regular act that keeps everything working long-term.

Posture: The Everyday Foundation



Posture is not about standing like a soldier — it is about giving your fascia a resting place that does not crank it into knots. You do not need perfect posture; you need varied, comfortable posture.

- Change position often — the best posture is your next one.
- Keep screens at eye level so you do not curl toward them.
- Soften the shoulders back and down, not pinned.
- When you become aware of slumping, gently lengthen through the crown.
- Release work supports posture because it frees the tissue that posture rests on.

A Gentler Path for Sensitive Bodies



If you have very sensitive tissue, low tolerance for pressure, fibromyalgia, or you simply prefer a softer start — there is a gentler way. Release is not a test of toughness; it should feel welcoming, not punishing.

- Start with breath work and stretching alone for the first weeks.
- Use a soft roller or even a rolled-up towel until you are comfortable.
- Keep sessions to 3–5 minutes and pressure feather-light.
- Reduce frequency if you feel sore the next day.
- Progress on your own timeline — there is no race.

Honor exactly where you are. A practice that feels safe is one you will actually keep.

When to See a Professional



I love self-care, and I also believe in knowing when to bring in skilled hands. Self-release is wonderful for daily maintenance; it is not the answer to everything.

- Struggling with ongoing pain that does not improve with consistency.
- A recent injury, fall or flare-up — get assessed before self-treating.
- Sharp, shooting or worsening pain at any time.
- A diagnosed condition (osteoporosis, spine, circulation, blood thinners).
- You feel unsure or anxious about what you are doing.

A physiotherapist or qualified bodyworker can tailor a plan to you. That is not failure — it is wisdom.

Adapting to Your Limits



Some days your body has more to give, and some days it needs gentleness. The skill of this practice is learning to meet it where it is. Scaling down is not 'failing' the routine — it is the routine working.

- Bad day? Do one zone in three minutes instead of ten.
- Tight hip? Give that one area your full ten minutes.
- Exhausted? Just breathe and roll the calves for two minutes.
- The only failure is skipping entirely for weeks at a stretch.
- Returning gently is what actually builds the habit.

Fascia and the Pains of Daily Life



Most of us are not chasing athletic performance — we just want to carry groceries, bend to the garden, play with a grandchild, or ride a few pleasant miles without discomfort. Here is how the release work maps to those everyday aches. Annoying daily pain Where the tension hides First move to try Tight, heavy shoulders Upper back and trapezius Roll the upper back, breathe Lower-back ache at day's end Glutes and hip flexors Ball on glutes, rock pelvis Stiffness after sitting Hamstrings and hips Hamstring roll, seated twist Sore feet and arches Plantar fascia Roll the arches with a ball Creaky knees Quads and calves Quad stretch, calf roll This is not a cure for a medical condition — it is a place to start understanding where your body holds its story.

Riding-Ready Mobility



Because riding matters so much to me, I keep a short 'ready-to-ride' sequence that prepares the body for the bike and helps me enjoy every mile with less effort.

- Open the hips with a pigeon stretch on each side.
- Free the glutes with the ball — the pedal-stroke engine.
- Open the chest and shoulders to counter the forward posture.
- Warm the calves and ankles with gentle rolls.
- Take 3 deep breaths standing on the bike, shoulders soft.

A three-minute sequence, done before the first mile, makes the whole ride feel different.

Your Next Step

« You don't have to get younger. You can get stronger. » Start small: roller under your calves, three breaths, ten minutes. Consistency beats intensity. Whatever stage of this transition you're in — just starting to notice changes, or years into them — your body will thank you over the coming weeks, and so will your energy. When you are ready, share what you notice — I love hearing how other people's bodies come alive again. And if a doctor or physiotherapist ever gives you a different answer, always follow their guidance over anything in this guide.